

Fernando Abreu

Director / Senior Manager · Technology Delivery & Professional Services

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PMP

CSPO

CSM

ITIL

MBA

CMMI



SUMMARY

People-first delivery leader with 25 years in technology services — a builder of teams, not just programs. Founded and scaled a professional services practice from zero to **22 consultants and engineers**, owning hiring, career development, utilization, and P&L. Now in year 10 at Microsoft leading the Americas Enterprise team accountable for delivery risk and quality across the Fortune 500 portfolio — coaching senior practitioners, setting the operating rhythm, and representing the group to executives. Engineer by origin, manager by choice: technical enough to earn credibility with engineering teams, commercial enough to own margin, and deliberate about growing the people who do the work.

KEY PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

Building & Growing Teams: Hired, onboarded, and developed technical talent across two continents — engineers, consultants, architects, and project managers — defining role ladders, competency frameworks, and interview loops. Runs 1:1s and calibration with intent: development plans, stretch assignments, internal mobility, promotion advocacy. Comfortable with the hard half of management — performance conversations, workload rebalancing, and re-teaming when the work changes.

Running a Delivery Organization: Owns the operating rhythm — capacity and staffing plans, utilization and margin targets, escalation paths, and a monthly business review cadence with executives. Manages blended teams of employees, contractors, and system-integrator partners against a single quality bar, backed by delivery playbooks, reusable IP, automated reporting, and a lessons-learned loop that actually changes the next engagement.

Leading Through Influence & Change: Orchestrates across sales, engineering, procurement, legal, and partner organizations where none of them report to me. Trusted by executives to carry difficult messages — at-risk programs, cost overruns, contract remediation — with the data to back them. Champions new ways of working by piloting with volunteers first and scaling on evidence, not mandate.

KEY ACTIVITIES & PROGRAMS

Practice Building from Zero: Stood up an Application Development practice end to end — service catalog, delivery methodology, rate card, recruiting pipeline, go-to-market story — growing headcount in step with demand rather than ahead of it, and building a partner/subcontractor network to flex capacity through peaks without over-hiring.

Talent Development & Culture: Mentors project managers and delivery leads inside and outside my reporting line; several have moved into senior and lead roles.

Deliberate about psychological safety in a risk-and-escalation function — the team is expected to raise bad news early, and is protected when they do.

Commercial & P&L Ownership: Full lead-to-order and order-to-cash accountability at Dexian — forecasting, pricing, contract closure, profitability analysis. At Microsoft, shapes commercial models and governs partner performance, rate adherence, and compliance so delivery quality and margin hold together.

Modernizing How the Team Works: Championed 10+ organization-wide initiatives — capacity-based staffing, platform migrations, approval-workflow automation, AI-assisted risk assessment. Builds the tooling hands-on when needed — three companion AI agents now used for portfolio monitoring — then hands it to the team as a durable capability.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- ★ Founded and scaled an Application Development practice from 0 to **22 people** — hiring, career ladders, utilization and P&L ownership
- ★ Team Lead, Americas Enterprise segment — leads the delivery risk & quality function across the most complex Fortune 500 programs in the portfolio
- ★ Championed 10+ organization-wide initiatives on how teams deliver — capacity-based staffing, platform modernization, and approval-workflow automation
- ★ Built and shipped 3 companion AI agents now used for portfolio monitoring — turning a personal experiment into a team capability
- ★ Manages blended teams of employees, contractors, and global system-integrator partners against one quality bar

SKILLS

People Leadership

Hiring & Interview Loops Coaching & Mentoring
Career Ladders Performance Management
Org Design Onboarding & Ramp

Delivery Management

Portfolio Management Capacity & Staffing
Utilization & Margin Risk & Escalation
Vendor & Partner Mgmt Executive Reporting

Practices

Agile / Scrum Kanban DevOps SDLC
CMMI PMO Methodology Design Thinking

Technical Fluency

Azure Cloud Adoption Applied & Agentic AI
Software Engineering Solution Architecture

ANCHOR ACCOUNTS

AT&T AWS Chevron Coca-Cola
Constellation Disney Domino's
Electronic Arts ExxonMobil FedEx Ford
GM-Cruise Lumen Manpower NBA NFL
Nike Pepsico Press Ganey T-Mobile
The GAP Verizon WarnerBros.

PARTNERS & VENDORS MANAGED

TCS Infosys Wipro Cognizant Capgemini
Deloitte Avanade Accenture IBM
Blue Yonder 3Cloud

Microsoft · 10 years

July 2016 – Present

Principal Program Manager · Team Lead, Americas Enterprise · Professional Services · Richmond, VA

Leads the delivery risk and quality function for the Americas Enterprise segment — a team of senior program managers covering the most complex Fortune 500 engagements in the portfolio. Sets the operating rhythm (monthly business reviews, escalation paths, lessons-learned loop), coaches practitioners through at-risk programs and hard customer conversations, and represents the group to delivery and sales executives. Owns partner and subcontractor performance end to end — selection, onboarding, rate adherence, compliance, remediation — across blended teams of employees, contractors, and global system integrators. Has championed 10+ organization-wide changes to how teams deliver, including AI-assisted risk tooling built hands-on and handed to the team.

Dexian-Disys · 6 years

Nov 2010 – Jun 2016

Practice Manager, Application Development · Houston, TX → Washington D.C. Metro Built an Application Development practice from a blank page and led it to **22 people at peak** — engineers, consultants, architects, and project managers. Owned the full people lifecycle: recruiting pipeline and interview loop, onboarding, role ladders and compensation banding, 1:1s and development plans, promotions, and the harder conversations when performance or fit didn't hold. Owned the practice P&L — forecasting, pricing, utilization and bench management, contract closure, profitability analysis. Built a partner and subcontractor network to flex capacity through peaks without over-hiring, and stayed the senior escalation point on every engagement the practice delivered.

Meta Brasil · 8 years

Sep 2002 – Oct 2010

SW Engineer → Dev Lead → Sr. Consultant → Technical Program Manager · Porto Alegre, Brazil

Grew from individual contributor to first-line leadership over eight years — leading development squads as Dev Lead, then running client-facing consulting engagements and technical programs. Mentored junior engineers, stood up PMO and delivery methodologies for outsourcing operations, and advised clients on IT & business integration. This is where I learned that the interesting problem is almost never the technology.

Dinamize Web Systems · 4 years

Aug 2000 – Jul 2004

Full Stack Software Engineer · Porto Alegre, Brazil

Where it all began. Built client-server and web-based applications using Delphi, Visual Basic, ASP.NET, and SQL Server. Developed foundational skills in database administration, UX/UI wireframing, and product engineering.

ACADEMIC BACKGROUND

Master's in Business Strategy

Unisinos · Magna cum laude

Associate's in Software Engineering

Escola Técnica Santo Inácio

B.S. Computer Science

PUC Rio Grande do Sul · Summa cum laude

PMP

Project Management Institute

CSPO · CSM

Scrum Alliance

ITIL

Exin

CMMI SCAMPI A & B

SEI Carnegie Mellon

LANGUAGES

English Native

Portuguese Native

French Proficient

Spanish Conversational

VOICES

"I have unwavering confidence in everything you do. I have witnessed your exponential growth over the years. You are intentional, focused, and do not shy away from challenges. I genuinely see you as a leader in your field."

Dawna Covey

Enterprise Account Delivery Lead · Microsoft

"Fernando is one of the most knowledgeable and effective resources I have come across in my +20yrs at MSFT. Your approach and structured working style keeping Team on point for the multitude of tasks and approvals it takes is SUPER. VERY few can accomplish this."

Adam Ryncarz

Ford/GM/Cruise Account Delivery Executive · Microsoft

"Strong technical acumen and genuine depth in AI — including testing, evaluation, and applied projects. An excellent communicator, effective at engaging stakeholders at all levels, who builds buy-in and shows real curiosity about the business and the team."

Stephen Wonton

Senior Leader · Microsoft

"Fernando and I are on the same page 99% of the time, which makes it really easy to work through issues when they arise. He is a very collaborative partner and is genuinely interested in coming up with acceptable solutions to very difficult challenges, often in extremely tight timelines."

Joe Newel

Architect Manager · Microsoft

HOBBIES & INTERESTS

- "That One Picture" — amateur photography
- "Project Footprint" — 30+ countries visited
- Water Sports, Skiing, 10k Running, HIIT
- F1, Broadway, Major Leagues, World Travel
- "The Book of Alessia Faye" — Girl Dad
- Pet parent (Doce & Salgada)
- Reading — J. Grisham, M. Gladwell, W. Isaacson
- Passe Completo Rádio! & How I Built This